GROW FOOD SYSTEM

ACTION KIT

Space & Planting Planner

Map your growing space, choose the right crops for your conditions, and create a planting plan that works. Fill it in, keep it updated, and use it every season.

- Assess your growing conditions
- Match crops to your space and climate
- Plan your layout before you plant
- Track what works season by season

My growing space

Fill in the details below. This assessment helps you choose the right crops and avoid planting things that will not work in your conditions.

SPACE TYPE

e.g. back garden, balcony, patio, windowsill, allotment

APPROXIMATE SIZE

e.g. 3m × 4m, 2 window boxes, 1 raised bed

DIRECTION IT FACES

N / S / E / W

HOURS OF SUN (SUMMER)

e.g. 4–6 hours

SOIL TYPE (IF KNOWN)

clay / sandy / loam / pots

Conditions checklist

- [ ] Gets at least 4 hours of direct sun in growing season
- [ ] Has access to water (tap, hose, or watering can reach)
- [ ] Soil drains well (no standing water after rain)
- [ ] Sheltered from strong or persistent wind
- [ ] Easy to reach daily for checking and watering
- [ ] Not heavily shaded by trees, buildings, or fences

NOTES ABOUT MY SPACE

Anything else relevant: frost pockets, slopes, nearby trees, shade at certain times of day, drainage issues

NO PERFECT SPACE

Every growing space has limitations. The goal is to work with what you have, not to find perfect conditions. Most food can be grown in surprisingly small or imperfect spaces.

Choose your crops

Use this table to find crops that match your conditions. Tick the ones you want to grow, then choose 2–4 to start with.

CROP	SUN NEEDED	SPACE	DIFFICULTY	CONTAINER?	GROW?
HERBS					
Basil	Full sun	Small pot	Easy	Yes	
Mint	Any	Small pot	Very easy	Yes (contained)	
Parsley	Part shade OK	Small pot	Easy	Yes	
Chives	Sun / part shade	Small pot	Very easy	Yes	
Rosemary	Full sun	Pot / border	Easy	Yes	
Thyme	Full sun	Small pot	Easy	Yes	
VEGETABLES					
Lettuce	Part shade OK	Window box	Easy	Yes	
Tomatoes	Full sun	Large pot / bed	Moderate	Yes (large)	
Courgettes	Full sun	Large pot / bed	Easy	Yes (v. large)	
Beans	Full sun	Bed / large pot	Easy	Possible	
Peas	Sun / part shade	Bed / pot	Easy	Yes	
Radishes	Sun / part shade	Any container	Very easy	Yes	
Kale / chard	Part shade OK	Bed / pot	Easy	Yes	
Potatoes	Full sun	Bag / large pot	Easy	Yes	
FRUIT					
Strawberries	Full sun	Pot / bed	Easy	Yes	
Raspberries	Sun / part shade	Bed / large pot	Easy	Possible	

MY CHOSEN CROPS (2–4 TO START)

My layout plan

Sketch your growing area below. Mark where each crop will go, where the sun falls, and where water access is. A rough plan is better than no plan.

Mark sun direction with an arrow

Mark water access point

Key

SCALE (OPTIONAL)

e.g. 1 square = 50cm x 50cm

SEASON / YEAR

LAYOUT TIPS

Put tall plants (tomatoes, beans) on the north side so they do not shade shorter crops. Group herbs together near the kitchen door. Place containers where you will see them every day — out of sight means forgotten.

Layout plan — next season or second area

Use this grid for your next season's layout or a second growing area. Compare with your previous plan to see what changed and why.

Mark sun direction with an arrow

Mark water access point

SCALE (OPTIONAL)

e.g. 1 square = 50cm x 50cm

SEASON / YEAR

WHAT I CHANGED FROM LAST TIME AND WHY

Season tracker

Record what you planted each season and how it went. Review this before planning the next season.

CROP	PLANTED	FIRST PICK	RESULT	NOTES / NEXT TIME

Lessons from this season

Write down what you learned. This is the most valuable part of the planner — your own experience, in your own words.

WHAT WORKED WELL

WHAT I WOULD DO DIFFERENTLY

WHAT I WANT TO TRY NEXT SEASON

PRINT A FRESH COPY EACH SEASON

Comparing seasons side by side is the fastest way to improve your growing results year on year.